

- H -

hallucinogen – mind-altering drug that tends to distort a person’s perception of direction, distance, and time

hazard flasher – a device that flashes front turn signal lights and taillights to warn others the vehicle is a hazard

head restraints – specially designed air bag or padded devices on the backs of front seats helping to reduce whiplash injuries in a side or rear impact collision

highway hypnosis – drowsy or trance-like condition caused by concentration on the road ahead and monotony of driving

hydroplaning – occurs when a tire patch loses contact with the road by rising up on top of water

highway – the width between the boundary lines of a publicly maintained way any part of which is open to the public for vehicular travel

- I -

ignition interlock device – a special mechanical control device installed on a motor vehicle’s dashboard. A driver must exhale into the device to start the vehicle. The court-ordered installation of an interlock ignition device must be performed by a DPS-certified service center

implied-consent law – anyone who receives a driver license automatically consents to be tested for blood-alcohol content and other drugs if stopped for suspicion of alcohol or drug usage while driving

intoxilyzer – the breath-test instrument machine commonly used for determining blood-alcohol content

- J -**- K -****- L -**

lane change – lateral maneuver moving the vehicle from one lane to another using proper space management procedures

lane signal – a signal, usually overhead, indicating if a lane can or cannot be used at a specific time

liability insurance – provides compensation for damages which the insured is legally obligated to pay; covers others when you are at fault

light truck – a truck with a manufacturer’s rated carrying capacity of not more than 2,000 lbs., including a pick up truck, panel delivery truck, and carry-all truck

limited use lanes – traffic flow lanes posted and designed to accommodate special vehicles or carpools

- M -

median – area of ground separating traffic moving in opposite directions

merging area – stretch of road at the end of an acceleration lane on an expressway where vehicles join the flow of traffic

minimum speed limit – speed limit to keep traffic moving safely by not allowing drivers to drive slower than a certain speed

moped – a motor-driven cycle that cannot attain a speed in one mile of more than 30 mph and the engine:

1. Cannot produce more than two-brake horsepower; and
2. If an internal combustion engine, has a piston displacement of 50 cubic centimeters or less and connects to a power drive system that does not require the operator to shift gears. Two-wheeled vehicle that can be driven with either a motor or pedal.

motorcycle – a motor vehicle, other than a tractor, equipped with a rider’s saddle and designed to have when propelled not more than three wheels on the ground

- N -

night blindness – not being able to see well at night

no-fault insurance – covers an insured’s losses and expenses associated with a collision regardless of fault